

Word family: return / returns / returned / returning / returnable / non-returnable / returnee

Base word: return

Part of speech: mainly **verb** and **noun**

Related forms:

- **return** (v.) — 返回; 歸還; 退回; 回復; 回應; 回報
- **return** (n.) — 返回; 歸還; 退貨; 回報; 收益; 申報表; 來回票
- **returns** (plural n.) — 退貨; 收益; 回報; 統計 / 申報資料
- **returning** (adj./participle) — 返回的; 再次出現的
- **returnable** (adj.) — 可退回的; 可退貨的; 須退還的
- **non-returnable** (adj.) — 不可退貨 / 不可退回的
- **returnee** (n.) — 回歸者; 返回原地 / 原國的人
- **return address** — 回郵地址
- **return journey / return flight / return ticket** — 回程 / 回程航班 / 來回票
- **return policy** — 退貨政策
- **return rate** — 退貨率; 回報率等, 視語境
- **return on investment / ROI** — 投資回報
- **tax return** — 報稅表
- **return value** — 回傳值
- **return statement** — return 敘述 / 返回敘述
- **Return key** — Return 鍵 / Enter 鍵
- **point of no return** — 無法回頭的臨界點

Major useful extensions:

return an item, return goods, return a purchase, return something for a refund, return something for exchange, return request, return policy, return window, return period, return postage, return shipping, return label, return rate, return pattern, return eligibility, qualify for return, be eligible for return, returnable item, non-returnable item, free returns, process a return, accept/refuse a return, initiate a return, make a return, product return, customer return, returns department, return to a place, return from somewhere, return home, return to work, return to normal, return to form, return to power, return to service, return something to someone, return a favour, return a call, return fire, return a smile, return a compliment, return to sender, return journey, return flight, return ticket, return visit, return match, in return, in return for, by return, rate of return, return on investment, financial return, annual return, total return, diminishing returns, return a profit, tax return,

election returns, return key, carriage return, return value, return statement, return code, return address, return receipt, return serve, return the ball, point of no return.

Meaning in this passage

Your passage uses the **return** family repeatedly:

Final-sale items, underwear, earrings and other hygiene-sensitive goods should remain **non-returnable**...

every **return request** should require an order number...

unusual **return patterns** [should be] flagged for review.

the item would no longer qualify for **return**.

we can review complaint volume, repeat purchases and **return rates**...

Here, the central meaning is:

the act/process of sending or taking a purchased item back to the seller —
退貨; 退回商品

And:

returnable = 符合條件可以退回商戶的

non-returnable = 不接受退貨的

This passage therefore uses the **retail / e-commerce branch** of **return**, not the more basic “go back somewhere” branch.

中文翻譯：

- **return request** = 退貨申請
 - **return pattern** = 退貨模式／退貨紀錄模式
 - **qualify for return** = 符合退貨資格
 - **return postage** = 退貨郵費
 - **return rate** = 退貨率
 - **non-returnable** = 不可退貨的
-

A. RETAIL: RETURN A PURCHASE

1. return an item/product = take/send it back to the seller — 退貨; 退回商品

This is the central branch in your passage.

Practice 1

Customers should be allowed to **return defective items**.

顧客應可以退回有缺陷的商品。

Practice 2

She returned the dress because the zip was broken.

她因為拉鏈壞了而退回那條裙。

Practice 3

The store allows customers to return unwanted goods within fourteen days.

商店容許顧客在十四天內退回不想要的商品。

MCQ-ready definition:

return an item = 購買後把商品送回／帶回商戶，通常要求退款、換貨或其他處理

2. return something for a refund — 退貨退款

Practice 1

She **returned the blouse for a refund**.

她把襯衫退回並要求退款。

Practice 2

Defective items may be returned for a full refund.

有缺陷的商品可以退貨並獲全額退款。

3. return something for exchange — 退貨換貨

Practice 1

The customer returned the shoes **for an exchange**.

顧客把鞋退回換貨。

Practice 2

You may return the item for a different size.

你可以退回商品並更換尺寸。

4. return goods / merchandise — 退回貨品

Practice 1

Customers must return the goods in their original condition.

顧客必須把貨品以原本狀態退回。

Practice 2

Returned merchandise is inspected before a refund is issued.

退回的商品會在退款前接受檢查。

B. A RETURN = A RETAIL RETURN

5. a return = an item sent back to the seller — 一宗退貨；退回商品

Practice 1

The warehouse processes hundreds of **returns** each week.

倉庫每星期處理數百宗退貨。

Practice 2

This return was rejected because the item had been worn.

這宗退貨申請因商品曾被穿着而被拒絕。

MCQ-ready definition:

a return = 顧客把購買的商品退回商戶的一宗交易／個案

6. process a return — 處理退貨

Practice 1

Staff should **process returns** consistently.

員工應以一致方式處理退貨。

Practice 2

The system automatically processes simple returns.

系統會自動處理簡單退貨個案。

7. accept a return — 接受退貨

Practice 1

The store will **accept the return** if the tags are still attached.

如果吊牌仍在，商店會接受退貨。

Practice 2

We cannot accept returns on hygiene-sensitive products.

我們不能接受衛生敏感商品的退貨。

8. refuse / reject a return — 拒絕退貨

Practice 1

The warehouse may **reject a return** if the item is stained.

如果商品有污漬，倉庫可能會拒絕退貨。

Practice 2

The return was refused because the deadline had passed.

因為已超過期限，這宗退貨申請被拒絕。

9. initiate / start a return — 發起退貨程序

Practice 1

Customers can **initiate a return** online.

顧客可以在網上開始退貨程序。

Practice 2

Enter your order number to start a return.

輸入訂單編號以辦理退貨。

C. RETURN REQUEST / ELIGIBILITY

10. return request — 退貨申請

Directly from your passage.

Practice 1 — passage-linked

Every **return request** should require an order number and a reason.

每宗退貨申請都應要求提供訂單編號和退貨原因。

Practice 2

The return request was approved after staff reviewed the photos.

員工檢查照片後批准了退貨申請。

11. qualify for return — 符合退貨資格

Practice 1 — passage-linked

Once the tag is removed, the item would no longer **qualify for return**.

一旦移除吊牌，商品便不再符合退貨資格。

Practice 2

Worn items do not qualify for return.

穿過的商品不符合退貨條件。

12. be eligible for return — 符合退貨資格

Practice 1

The item is **eligible for return** within fourteen days.

商品在十四天內符合退貨資格。

Practice 2

Final-sale products are not eligible for return.

清貨貨品不可退貨。

13. return eligibility — 退貨資格

Practice 1

The website clearly explains **return eligibility**.

網站清楚說明退貨資格。

Practice 2

Condition and purchase date determine return eligibility.

商品狀態和購買日期會決定是否符合退貨條件。

D. RETURNABLE / NON-RETURNABLE

14. returnable = allowed/capable of being returned — 可退貨的; 可退回的

Practice 1

Most unworn clothing is **returnable** within fourteen days.

大部分未穿過的衣物在十四天內可以退貨。

Practice 2

Check whether the item is returnable before removing the tag.

移除吊牌前，先檢查商品是否可以退貨。

MCQ-ready definition:

returnable = 按規則可以交回商戶／原擁有者的

15. non-returnable = cannot be returned — 不可退貨／不可退回的

Exact passage word.

Practice 1 — original passage

Hygiene-sensitive goods should remain **non-returnable**.

衛生敏感商品應繼續列為不可退貨商品。

Practice 2

Earrings are non-returnable for hygiene reasons.

耳環因衛生原因不可退貨。

MCQ-ready definition:

non-returnable = 根據規則不接受退回的

16. returnable container / bottle — 須／可 退回的容器／樽

A related but slightly different branch.

Practice 1

The drink comes in a **returnable bottle**.

飲品使用可退回重用的樽。

Practice 2

Returnable containers can be reused.

回收重用容器可以再次使用。

Here **returnable** may mean:

should/can be returned to the supplier for reuse,
not necessarily a retail refund.

E. RETURN POLICY

17. return policy — 退貨政策

Practice 1

The company needs a clearer **return policy**.

公司需要更清晰的退貨政策。

Practice 2

Read the return policy before buying final-sale items.

購買清貨商品前應閱讀退貨政策。

MCQ-ready definition:

return policy = 商戶規定顧客在甚麼情況、期限和條件下可以退貨的規則

18. returns policy — 退貨政策

Especially common in BrE/business English.

Practice 1

The retailer revised its **returns policy**.

零售商修訂了退貨政策。

Practice 2

A flexible returns policy can increase customer confidence.

較靈活的退貨政策可以提升顧客信心。

Both are used:

return policy
returns policy

F. RETURN WINDOW / PERIOD

19. return window — 可退貨期限

Practice 1

The **return window** is fourteen days.

退貨期限為十四天。

Practice 2

The item was sent back after the return window had closed.

商品在退貨期限過後才被退回。

20. return period — 退貨期

Practice 1

The retailer shortened the **return period**.

零售商縮短了退貨期。

Practice 2

Customers should know the return period before payment.

顧客在付款前應知道退貨期限。

G. RETURN POSTAGE / SHIPPING

21. return postage — 退貨郵費

Directly related to your passage.

Practice 1

Customers could pay **return postage** for ordinary exchanges.

一般換貨的退貨郵費可由顧客支付。

Practice 2

The company covers return postage for defective goods.

有缺陷商品的退貨郵費由公司承擔。

22. return shipping — 退貨運費

Practice 1

Free **return shipping** is available for faulty items.

有問題的商品可享免費退貨運送。

Practice 2

Return shipping costs can be expensive for international orders.

國際訂單的退貨運費可能很高。

23. return label — 退貨標籤

Practice 1

Print the **return label** and attach it to the parcel.

列印退貨標籤並貼在包裹上。

Practice 2

The email included a prepaid return label.

電郵附有一張已付費的退貨標籤。

H. RETURN RATE

24. return rate = percentage of products returned — 退貨率

This is the exact passage sense.

Practice 1 — passage-linked

After the pilot, we can review complaint volume, repeat purchases and **return rates**.

試行期後，我們可以檢視投訴數量、重複購買和退貨率。

Practice 2

Poor sizing information can increase the return rate.

尺碼資訊不準確可能提高退貨率。

MCQ-ready definition:

return rate = 售出商品中被顧客退回的比例

25. high / low return rate — 高／低退貨率

Practice 1

This dress has an unusually high **return rate**.

這款裙的退貨率異常地高。

Practice 2

Better size charts may reduce return rates.

更準確的尺碼表可能降低退貨率。

Important warning: return rate has another major meaning

In finance:

rate of return

means:

回報率／收益率

So:

product return rate = 退貨率
investment rate of return = 投資回報率

Context is essential.

I. RETURN PATTERN

26. return pattern — 退貨模式／退貨行為模式

Directly from your passage.

Practice 1

Unusual **return patterns** should be flagged for review.

異常的退貨模式應被標記作進一步審查。

Practice 2

The system detects repeated return patterns.

系統會偵測反覆出現的退貨行為模式。

This is not a highly lexicalized dictionary phrase, but it is completely natural business English.

J. FREE RETURNS

27. free returns — 免費退貨

Practice 1

The retailer offers **free returns**.

零售商提供免費退貨。

Practice 2

Free returns may increase customer confidence but also increase costs.

免費退貨可能提升顧客信心，但也可能增加成本。

28. free-return policy — 免費退貨政策

Practice 1

The company is reviewing its free-return policy.

公司正在檢討免費退貨政策。

Practice 2

A free-return policy may affect ordering behaviour.

免費退貨政策可能影響顧客下單行為。

K. RETURN = GO BACK TO A PLACE

29. return to a place = go/come back — 返回；回到

The most basic verb branch.

Practice 1

She **returned to the office** after lunch.

她午飯後回到辦公室。

Practice 2

We returned to the hotel late.

我們很晚才返回酒店。

MCQ-ready definition:

return to X = 再次回到之前曾經所在的地方

30. return from somewhere — 從某地回來

Practice 1

He **returned from London** yesterday.

他昨天從倫敦回來。

Practice 2

She returned from her trip on Monday.

她星期一旅行回來。

31. return home — 回家

Practice 1

He returned home after the meeting.

他開完會後回家。

Practice 2

Many travellers returned home early.

很多旅客提早回家。

Grammar note:

return home ✓
return to home ✗ normally

because **home** commonly functions adverbially here.

32. return safely — 安全返回

Practice 1

Everyone returned safely.

所有人都安全返回。

Practice 2

The crew returned safely from the mission.

人員完成任務後安全歸來。

L. RETURN = COME BACK / REAPPEAR

33. return = come back after absence — 再次出現；回歸

Practice 1

The problem **returned** a few weeks later.

幾星期後，問題再次出現。

Practice 2

Warm weather returned in March.

三月時暖和天氣再次出現。

MCQ-ready definition:

return = 某人／某事在消失、離開或停止一段時間後再次出現

34. **return of something** —的回歸／再次出現

Practice 1

Customers welcomed the **return of the popular design**.

顧客歡迎這款受歡迎設計重新推出。

Practice 2

The return of confidence helped sales.

信心的恢復有助銷售。

35. **a welcome return** — 令人歡迎的回歸

Practice 1

The product made a **welcome return** to the catalogue.

這款產品重新上架，受到歡迎。

Practice 2

Her return to the team was warmly welcomed.

她重返團隊受到熱烈歡迎。

M. **RETURN TO A STATE / CONDITION**

36. return to normal — 恢復正常

A major expression.

Practice 1

Sales gradually **returned to normal**.

銷售逐漸恢復正常。

Practice 2

Operations should return to normal tomorrow.

營運應於明天恢復正常。

37. return to form — 恢復良好狀態／水準

Especially sport/performance.

Practice 1

The team finally **returned to form**.

球隊終於恢復良好狀態。

Practice 2

Sales returned to form after a weak quarter.

銷售在一季表現疲弱後恢復正常水準。

38. return to profitability — 恢復盈利

Practice 1

The business **returned to profitability**.

企業恢復盈利。

Practice 2

Management hopes the division will return to profitability next year.

管理層希望該事業部明年能恢復盈利。

39. return to work — 復工；重返工作

Practice 1

She **returned to work** after the holiday.

假期後她復工。

Practice 2

Employees returned to work after the disruption ended.

中斷結束後，員工重新上班。

40. return to service — 恢復服務／重新投入使用

Practice 1

The repaired machine **returned to service**.

修好的機器重新投入使用。

Practice 2

The train returned to service after inspection.

列車完成檢查後恢復服務。

N. RETURN SOMETHING = GIVE IT BACK

41. return something to someone = give it back — 歸還

A major distinct verb sense.

Practice 1

Please **return the key to reception**.

請把鎖匙歸還接待處。

Practice 2

She **returned the borrowed book**.

她歸還了借來的書。

MCQ-ready definition:

return something = 把原本屬於別人／借來／拿走的東西交回

42. return borrowed property — 歸還借用物品

Practice 1

All equipment must be **returned after use**.

所有設備使用後必須歸還。

Practice 2

He forgot to **return the charger**.

他忘記歸還充電器。

43. return something to its owner — 物歸原主

Practice 1

The wallet was **returned to its owner**.

銀包已經物歸原主。

Practice 2

Lost property should be returned to its rightful owner.

失物應歸還原本的擁有者。

O. RETURN TO SENDER

44. return to sender — 退回寄件人

A major postal expression.

Practice 1

The parcel was marked “**Return to Sender.**”

包裹被標示為「退回寄件人」。

Practice 2

Undeliverable mail is often returned to the sender.

無法派遞的郵件通常會退回寄件人。

45. return address — 回郵地址；寄件人地址

Practice 1

Write your **return address** on the envelope.

在信封上寫上你的回郵／寄件人地址。

Practice 2

The parcel had no return address.

包裹上沒有寄件人地址。

MCQ-ready definition:

return address = 郵件無法派遞時可退回的寄件人地址

P. RETURN SOMETHING = SEND BACK A RESPONSE

46. return a call — 回電話

Practice 1

I'll **return your call** this afternoon.

我今天下午會回你電話。

Practice 2

She never returned my call.

她一直沒有回電。

47. return a message/email — 回覆訊息／電郵

Less common than **reply to**, but valid.

Practice 1

He returned the message immediately.

他立即回覆訊息。

Practice 2

Please return my email when convenient.

方便時請回覆我的電郵。

48. return a smile — 回以微笑

Practice 1

She smiled, and he **returned the smile**.

她微笑，他也回以微笑。

Practice 2

The customer returned her smile.

顧客也對她報以微笑。

49. return a greeting — 回禮；回應問候

Practice 1

He nodded and **returned the greeting**.

他點頭回應問候。

Practice 2

She politely returned his greeting.

她有禮貌地回禮／回應他的問候。

50. return a compliment — 回敬讚美

Practice 1

She **returned the compliment**.

她也回讚了對方一句。

Practice 2

He praised her work, and she returned the compliment.

他稱讚她的工作，她也回敬了一句讚美。

Q. RETURN A FAVOUR

51. return a favour — 回報人情；還人情

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

She helped me last week, so I wanted to **return the favour**.

她上星期幫過我，所以我想還她一個人情。

Practice 2

I'll return the favour someday.

我有一天會回報你這個人情。

MCQ-ready definition:

return a favour = 別人曾幫助你後，以幫助對方作為回報

R. RETURN FIRE / ACTION

52. return fire — 還擊

Practice 1

The guards **returned fire**.

守衛開火還擊。

Practice 2

The phrase means firing back after being fired upon.

這個表達指在遭到射擊後開火反擊。

53. return the attack / blow — 反擊

Practice 1

The player immediately **returned the attack**.

選手立即反擊。

Practice 2

He returned the blow.

他回擊了一拳。

This is less universally common than **return fire**, but the reciprocal idea is established.

S. IN RETURN

54. in return = as a response or repayment — 作為回報

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

She helped me, and I helped her **in return**.

她幫助我，我也作為回報幫助她。

Practice 2

Customers give us loyalty; they expect fair treatment **in return**.

顧客給予我們忠誠度，作為交換／回報，他們也期望獲得公平待遇。

MCQ-ready definition:

in return = 因收到某物、服務或幫助而作出的相應回報

55. in return for something — 作為.....的回報／交換

Practice 1

Customers receive store credit **in return for the returned item**.

顧客退回商品後，作為交換獲得商店購物額。

Practice 2

He offered help in return for advice.

他提供幫助，交換對方的意見。

56. expect something in return — 期望得到回報

Practice 1

She helped without expecting anything **in return**.

她幫助別人，並不期望得到任何回報。

Practice 2

Customers expect value in return for the price they pay.

顧客期望自己付出的金錢能得到相應價值回報。

T. RETURN JOURNEY / TRAVEL

57. return journey — 回程；來回旅程中的回程

Especially BrE.

Practice 1

The **return journey** took three hours.

回程花了三小時。

Practice 2

Traffic was heavier on the return journey.

回程途中交通更繁忙。

58. return flight — 回程航班

Practice 1

Our **return flight** leaves on Sunday.

我們的回程航班星期日起飛。

Practice 2

She changed the date of her return flight.

她更改了回程航班日期。

59. return ticket — 來回票

Especially BrE.

Practice 1

I'd like a **return ticket** to London.

我想買一張去倫敦的來回票。

Practice 2

A return ticket was cheaper than buying two singles.

買來回票比買兩張單程票便宜。

BrE:

return ticket

AmE:

round-trip ticket

60. single vs return — 單程 vs 來回

BrE travel contrast:

a **single** to Manchester
單程票

a **return** to Manchester
來回票

61. a return = return ticket — 來回票

BrE noun shorthand.

Practice 1

“Single or **return**?”

「單程還是來回？」

Practice 2

Two returns to Brighton, please.

請給我兩張去 Brighton 的來回票。

U. RETURN VISIT / MATCH

62. return visit — 回訪

Practice 1

The client made a **return visit** the following month.

客戶下個月再次到訪／回訪。

Practice 2

We hope to arrange a return visit next year.

我們希望明年安排一次回訪。

63. return match / leg — 次回合；回賽

Sports.

Practice 1

The **return match** will be played next week.

次回合比賽將於下星期舉行。

Practice 2

They won the return leg 2–0.

他們在次回合以 2–0 勝出。

V. FINANCIAL RETURN

64. return = profit/gain produced by an investment — 回報；收益

A major distinct noun sense.

Practice 1

Investors want a reasonable **return**.

投資者希望獲得合理回報。

Practice 2

The investment produced a strong return.

這項投資帶來可觀收益。

MCQ-ready definition:

financial return = 投資帶來的盈利、收益或價值增長

65. return on investment / ROI — 投資回報

Practice 1

The project produced a strong **return on investment**.

項目帶來良好的投資回報。

Practice 2

Management compared the expected ROI of the two options.

管理層比較兩個方案的預期投資回報率。

66. rate of return — 回報率; 收益率

Practice 1

The investment has an annual **rate of return** of 5%.

這項投資的年度回報率為 5%。

Practice 2

Higher expected returns often come with different levels of risk.

較高的預期回報通常伴隨不同程度的風險。

67. annual return — 年度回報

Practice 1

The fund reported a positive **annual return**.

基金錄得正的年度回報。

Practice 2

Compare annual returns over several years rather than one period alone.

比較投資時應檢視多年的年度回報，而不是只看一期。

68. total return — 總回報

Practice 1

Total return includes both price changes and relevant distributions.

總回報包括價格變動及相關分派收益。

Practice 2

Investors often compare total return rather than price movement alone.

投資者常比較總回報，而不只是價格變動。

69. return a profit — 帶來盈利

Practice 1

The new division finally **returned a profit**.

新事業部終於錄得盈利／帶來盈利。

Practice 2

The investment has yet to return a profit.

這項投資仍未產生盈利。

W. DIMINISHING RETURNS

70. diminishing returns — 邊際回報遞減；報酬遞減

A major economics/general idiom.

Practice 1

Adding more workers may eventually produce **diminishing returns**.

持續增加人手最終可能出現報酬遞減。

Practice 2

More meetings can reach a point of diminishing returns.

開更多會議可能最終出現效益遞減。

MCQ-ready definition:

diminishing returns = 額外投入繼續增加，但額外得到的收益／效果愈來愈小

71. point of diminishing returns — 回報開始遞減的臨界點

Practice 1

Beyond a certain point, extra advertising reaches the **point of diminishing returns**.

超過某個水平後，額外廣告便到達回報遞減點。

Practice 2

Longer meetings may eventually reach a point of diminishing returns.

會議開得太久，最終可能進入效益愈來愈低的階段。

X. TAX RETURN

72. tax return = official tax declaration/form — 報稅表；報稅申報

A completely different institutional sense.

Practice 1

She submitted her **tax return**.

她提交了報稅表。

Practice 2

The deadline for filing the tax return is approaching.

提交報稅申報的期限快到了。

MCQ-ready definition:

tax return = 向稅務機關申報收入、扣減等稅務資料的正式表格／申報文件

Important:

tax return ≠ tax refund

A tax return is the **form/declaration**.

A tax refund is:

退稅款.

73. file a tax return — 報稅; 提交報稅表

Practice 1

Some taxpayers must **file a tax return** annually.

部分納稅人需要每年提交報稅表。

Practice 2

He filed the return electronically.

他以電子方式提交申報表。

Y. RETURNS = REPORTS / STATISTICS

74. returns = official statistical reports/results — 統計回報; 申報資料

Formal/institutional.

Practice 1

Monthly sales **returns** were submitted to head office.

每月銷售統計回報資料已提交總部。

Practice 2

The department compiled annual returns.

部門整理了年度申報資料。

MCQ-ready definition:

returns = 定期提交的正式數據、報表或結果資料

This sense appears in administrative/business language.

Z. RETURN A VERDICT / FORMAL DECISION

75. return a verdict — 作出裁決

A legal fixed collocation.

Practice 1

The jury **returned a verdict**.

陪審團作出裁決。

Practice 2

A verdict was returned after several hours of deliberation.

經過數小時商議後，陪審團作出裁決。

MCQ-ready definition:

return a verdict = 正式宣布陪審團／法院所作出的判決結果

This is highly lexicalized: **return** here does not mean physically “bring back.”

AA. SPORTS: RETURN THE BALL / SERVE

76. return the ball = hit/send it back — 把球回擊回去

Practice 1

She **returned the ball** down the line.

她把球沿邊線回擊。

Practice 2

He returned the serve easily.

他輕鬆回擊發球。

MCQ-ready definition:

return the ball = 在對方擊球後，把球打回對方一邊

77. return a serve — 接發球並回擊

Practice 1

She is excellent at **returning serve**.

她很擅長接發球回擊。

Practice 2

The player failed to return the serve.

球員未能把發球回擊回去。

78. a return = returned shot — 回球

Practice 1

His **return** landed near the baseline.

他的回球落在底線附近。

Practice 2

She hit a powerful return.

她打出一記有力的回球。

79. return of serve / serve return — 接發球

Practice 1

Her **return of serve** is one of her strengths.

接發球是她的強項之一。

Practice 2

Good serve return requires anticipation.

良好的接發球能力需要預判。

AB. AMERICAN FOOTBALL ETC.: RETURN

80. return a kick/punt — 回攻踢球／棄踢

Sports-specific but established.

Practice 1

He **returned the kick** for a touchdown.

他回攻開球並達陣。

Practice 2

The player specialises in punt returns.

該球員專長於棄踢回攻。

81. kick return / punt return — 開球／棄踢回攻

Practice 1

The **kick return** gained thirty yards.

這次開球回攻推進了三十碼。

Practice 2

He works as a return specialist.

他專門負責回攻。

AC. COMPUTING: RETURN A VALUE

82. return a value = send a result back from a function — 回傳值

A major programming sense.

Practice 1

The function **returns a value**.

這個函數會回傳一個值。

Practice 2

If the input is invalid, the function returns an error code.

如果輸入無效，函數會回傳錯誤碼。

MCQ-ready definition:

return a value = 程式中的函數／程序完成後把結果傳回呼叫它的地方

83. return value — 回傳值

Practice 1

Store the **return value** in a variable.

把回傳值儲存在變數中。

Practice 2

The return value indicates whether the operation succeeded.

回傳值表示操作是否成功。

84. return statement — return 敘述；返回語句

Practice 1

The function ends with a **return statement**.

函數以一個 **return** 敘述結束。

Practice 2

A return statement can send a result back to the caller.

return 語句可以把結果傳回呼叫端。

85. return code — 回傳碼; 返回碼

Practice 1

The program returned a non-zero **return code**.

程式回傳了一個非零返回碼。

Practice 2

The return code helps indicate the result of an operation.

回傳碼可用來表示操作結果。

AD. KEYBOARD: RETURN KEY

86. Return key — Return 鍵; Enter 鍵

A major computing/typing term.

Practice 1

Press the **Return key**.

按下 **Return 鍵**。

Practice 2

On many keyboards, Return and Enter perform similar functions in common applications.

在很多鍵盤和一般應用中, **Return** 和 **Enter** 常有相近功能。

87. carriage return — 回車; 歸位符

Historical computing/typewriting term.

Practice 1

The file contains carriage-return characters.

檔案含有回車字元。

Practice 2

“Carriage return” originally comes from typewriter mechanics.

carriage return 一詞源自打字機的機械動作。

AE. RETURN RECEIPT

88. return receipt — 回執; 簽收回條

Practice 1

The letter was sent with a **return receipt**.

信件以附有簽收回條的方式寄出。

Practice 2

The return receipt confirms delivery.

回執可以確認郵件已送達。

AF. POINT OF NO RETURN

89. point of no return — 無法回頭的臨界點

A major figurative idiom.

Practice 1

The project had passed the **point of no return**.

項目已經越過無法回頭的臨界點。

Practice 2

Once production begins, the decision may reach a point of no return.

生產開始後，這個決定可能進入難以撤回的階段。

MCQ-ready definition:

point of no return = 一旦越過便無法合理回到原來狀態／撤回決定的階段

AG. RETURN TO THE SUBJECT / ACTIVITY

90. return to a topic/subject — 回到某個話題

Practice 1

Let's **return to the main issue**.

我們回到主要問題吧。

Practice 2

The report later returns to the question of customer trust.

報告稍後會再次討論顧客信任問題。

91. return to a task/activity — 重新做／繼續某活動

Practice 1

After lunch, they **returned to work**.

午飯後，他們重新工作。

Practice 2

She returned to the report after answering the call.

接完電話後，她重新處理報告。

AH. RETURN = GIVE BACK A POSITION / CONDITION

92. return something to normal — 使.....恢復正常

Practice 1

The repair **returned the machine to normal operation**.

維修令機器恢復正常運作。

Practice 2

The intervention returned the system to a stable state.

介入令系統恢復穩定狀態。

93. return something to its original condition — 恢復原狀

Practice 1

The room must be **returned to its original condition**.

房間必須恢復原狀。

Practice 2

The item should be returned in its original packaging.

商品應以原包裝退回。

Notice that this sentence can combine:

- **return = send back**
- **original condition = original state**

AI. RETURN = RECURRENCE

94. return of symptoms/problem — 症狀／問題復發

Practice 1

There was a **return of symptoms**.

症狀再次出現／復發。

Practice 2

The return of the problem surprised the team.

問題再次出現令團隊感到意外。

95. returning problem/customer — 再次出現的問題／回頭客

Practice 1

Returning customers are valuable to retailers.

回頭客／再次光顧的顧客對零售商很重要。

Practice 2

The system recognises returning users.

系統可以辨認再次使用服務的使用者。

AJ. RETURNING CUSTOMER

96. returning customer = customer who buys again — 回頭客；再次光顧的顧客

Highly relevant to your passage's **repeat business**.

Practice 1

A fair policy can encourage **returning customers**.

公平政策可以鼓勵顧客再次光顧。

Practice 2

Returning customers often have greater familiarity with the brand.

回頭客通常更熟悉品牌。

Important:

returning customer

does **not** mean:

a customer who is returning a product.

It usually means:

a customer coming back to buy/use again

Context is critical.

Important distinction 1: return vs exchange

Central to your passage.

return

商品被送回商戶。

exchange

原商品換成另一件：

- size,
- colour,
- model, etc.

So:

every exchange involves returning something physically,

but the transaction outcome differs:

return for refund → money back

return for exchange → replacement item.

Important distinction 2: return vs refund

Extremely important.

return

the **item goes back**.

refund

the **money goes back**.

Example:

The customer returned the dress.

顧客退回裙子。

The store issued a refund.

商店退款。

You can sometimes get:

refund without return

and sometimes:

return without cash refund, e.g. store credit.

Important distinction 3: return vs replacement

return

send original item back.

replacement

new item supplied to replace the faulty/wrong one.

Sequence:

defective item returned → replacement sent.

Important distinction 4: return vs store credit

return

physical goods come back.

store credit

customer receives spending value for future purchases instead of cash.

Your passage deliberately proposes:

change-of-mind return → **store credit**

rather than cash refund.

Important distinction 5: return vs cancellation

cancel

stop an order/contract before completion or according to cancellation rules.

return

goods have normally already been supplied/received and are then sent back.

Important distinction 6: return vs send back

send back

very everyday and literal.

return

more neutral/formal and has legal/retail/business uses.

send the dress back
把裙寄回去

return the dress
退回裙子

Important distinction 7: return vs give back

give back

ordinary interpersonal language.

return

more formal and works with:

- borrowed goods,
- purchased goods,
- documents,
- equipment.

give me my pen back
把我的筆還我

return the equipment after use
使用後歸還設備

Important distinction 8: returnable vs refundable

Very important.

returnable

item may be sent/taken back.

refundable

money/payment can be refunded.

A product could theoretically be:

returnable for exchange only

but:

not refundable for cash.

So:

returnable $\neq$ automatically refundable.

Important distinction 9: returnable vs exchangeable

returnable

can be sent back under policy.

exchangeable

can be swapped for another item.

Your passage proposes:

some items may be **exchangeable** for size/colour
without permitting every case to receive a cash refund.

Important distinction 10: non-returnable vs final sale

non-returnable

cannot be returned.

final sale

commercial label indicating the sale is final and usually not eligible for normal return/refund.

A retailer should state the actual policy clearly because practices can vary.

Important distinction 11: return postage vs delivery charge

delivery charge

cost of sending the original order to customer.

return postage

cost of sending the item back.

Your passage makes this distinction explicitly.

Important distinction 12: return rate vs repeat purchase rate

These move in very different directions:

return rate

how much merchandise comes back.

repeat purchase rate

how many customers buy again.

A policy may increase or decrease each independently.

Important distinction 13: returning customer vs returning product

Very easy learner trap.

returning customer

顧客再次回來購買 → 回頭客

customer returning a product

顧客把商品退回 → 退貨顧客／正在退貨的顧客

Important distinction 14: return = go back vs return something = give back

Intransitive:

She **returned to the shop**.
她回到商店。

Transitive:

She **returned the dress to the shop**.
她把裙子退回商店。

The presence of an object changes the grammatical structure.

Important distinction 15: return to vs return from

return to X

destination:

return to Hong Kong
返回香港

return from X

starting place:

return from Hong Kong
從香港回來

Important distinction 16: return vs come back / go back

All can describe returning.

come back

movement toward speaker/reference point.

go back

movement away/back to another place.

return

more neutral/formal; does not encode the speaker's viewpoint as strongly.

Important distinction 17: return = go back vs revert

return to normal

very natural.

revert to an earlier state

more formal and often means change back to previous behaviour/state.

return to normal

恢復正常

revert to the old system

恢復舊制度

Important distinction 18: return to form vs recover

return to form

regain a previously good performance level.

recover

recover from:

- illness,
- loss,
- setback,
- weak period.

A player may recover physically before fully returning to form.

Important distinction 19: return call vs call back

They are very close.

return someone's call

slightly more formal.

call someone back

ordinary conversational English.

I'll return your call.

I'll call you back.

Both = 我會回你電話.

Important distinction 20: return a favour vs repay

return a favour

respond to kindness/help with another kindness.

repay

can mean:

- repay money,
- repay kindness.

repay a loan
償還貸款

return a favour
還人情

Important distinction 21: in return vs instead

in return

reciprocal exchange:

I helped her; she helped me in return.

instead

replacement alternative:

I didn't take cash; I accepted store credit instead.

Completely different.

Important distinction 22: in return for vs because of

in return for

exchange relationship.

store credit in return for the item
用商品換取購物額

because of

causal relationship.

refund because of defect
因商品有缺陷而退款

Important distinction 23: return ticket vs return flight

return ticket

ticket covers outward + return travel, especially BrE.

return flight

specifically flight taking you back.

One ticket can include two flights:

- outbound flight,
 - return flight.
-

Important distinction 24: return vs round trip

BrE:

return ticket

AmE:

round-trip ticket

Very useful regional distinction.

Important distinction 25: financial return vs refund

Both can involve money coming back, but conceptually:

financial return

收益 generated by investment.

refund

money repaid because of a purchase/charge.

investment return = 投資回報

purchase refund = 退款

Important distinction 26: return vs profit

profit

earnings after relevant costs.

return

broader investor gain relative to investment and can include:

- income,
- price increase,
- distributions.

Not identical.

Important distinction 27: return vs yield

return

overall investment gain.

yield

often income generated relative to price/value over a period, depending on instrument.

They overlap but are not interchangeable in every finance context.

Important distinction 28: return rate in retail vs rate of return in finance

Again, an exam-quality distinction:

return rate of dresses = 退貨率

rate of return on shares = 投資回報率

Same word family, radically different meaning.

Important distinction 29: tax return vs tax refund

Critical:

tax return

報稅表／申報

tax refund

退稅

Submitting a tax return does not automatically mean receiving a tax refund.

Important distinction 30: return a verdict

This is a fixed legal expression.

It does not mean:

“send a verdict back.”

It means:

formally announce/deliver the verdict.

Important distinction 31: Return key vs return as verb

Capitalized or UI-context **Return** may simply mean the keyboard key.

Press Return.

No movement/retail meaning is active.

Important distinction 32: return value

In programming:

function returns X

means:

the function gives X back to the caller as its result

This metaphor is conceptually related to “give back,” but is now a specialized technical meaning.

Important distinction 33: return vs output in programming

From your earlier **output** family:

output

anything produced/emitted by system/function.

return value

specific value handed back by a function/call.

A function may:

- print output,
- modify state,
- and return a value.

These are not necessarily the same thing.

Important distinction 34: return vs recurrence

return

ordinary wording:

symptoms returned

recurrence

formal noun:

recurrence of symptoms

Both express coming back after absence.

Important distinction 35: return vs repeat

return

something previously gone/absent comes back.

repeat

same event/action happens again.

customer returns

顧客回來

customer repeats the purchase

顧客再次購買

This matters in your passage's **repeat business**.

Important distinction 36: return policy vs returns process

return policy

rules:

what is allowed?

returns process

operations:

how is a return actually submitted, inspected and completed?

A retailer can have a fair policy but a poor process.

Important distinction 37: return request vs return itself

return request

customer asks for authorization/processing.

return

actual retail transaction/item coming back.

A request may be:

approved
or
rejected.

So not every return request becomes a completed return.

Important distinction 38: return pattern vs return rate

return rate

numeric proportion.

return pattern

behavioural pattern:

- repeated sizes,
- repeated categories,
- timing,
- condition of goods,
- frequency.

Your passage uses both because they answer different questions.

Important distinction 39: return abuse

Although your passage doesn't use this exact compound, the whole paragraph describes it.

returns abuse / return abuse

misuse of a retailer's return policy.

Examples may include:

- wearing an item and returning it,
- repeatedly ordering with no genuine intention to keep,
- falsifying reasons.

This is broader than a legitimate high return rate.

Important distinction 40: return fraud vs return abuse

return fraud

usually involves deception/fraudulent conduct.

return abuse

broader policy misuse and does not necessarily involve fraud in every case.

Useful business distinction.

Important distinction 41: return in your passage

The passage does not treat **return** as one single transaction.

It builds an entire controlled system:

return request

→ customer states reason/evidence

return eligibility

→ check whether policy allows it

return inspection

→ tags/stains/perfume/damage checked

return outcome

→ exchange / refund / store credit / rejection

return pattern

→ repeated behaviour reviewed

return rate

→ overall business metric after pilot

That is a very sophisticated use of the **retail return** family.

Family-extension note

The **return** family has several major modern branches:

1. retail goods

- return an item
- process a return
- return request

2. retail eligibility

- returnable
- non-returnable
- qualify for return

3. retail policy

- return policy
- return window

4. retail logistics

- return postage
- return shipping
- return label

5. retail analytics

- return rate
- return pattern

6. physical movement

- return to a place
- return from somewhere

7. reappearance

- problem returns
- return of confidence

8. restored state

- return to normal
- return to form

9. give something back

- return equipment
- return borrowed goods

10. postal

- return to sender
- return address
- return receipt

11. reciprocal response

- return a call
- return a smile
- return a favour

12. response/retaliation

- return fire

13. exchange

- in return
- in return for

14. travel

- return journey
- return flight
- return ticket

15. financial gain

- investment return
- rate of return
- ROI

16. economics

- diminishing returns

17. tax

- tax return

18. administrative statistics

- annual/monthly returns

19. law

- return a verdict

20. sport

- return serve
- return the ball

21. programming

- return value
- return statement

22. keyboard

- Return key
- carriage return

23. idiom

- point of no return

24. repeat customers

- returning customer

For your passage, the exact branch is:

return = the process by which a customer sends or brings purchased merchandise back to the retailer under stated conditions

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
return an item	退貨 ; 退回商品	retail
return goods	退回貨品	retail
return for a refund	退貨退款	retail outcome
return for exchange	退貨換貨	retail outcome
a return	一宗退貨	retail noun
process a return	處理退貨	retail operations
accept a return	接受退貨	policy
reject a return	拒絕退貨	policy
initiate a return	開始退貨程序	process
return request	退貨申請	passage
qualify for return	符合退貨資格	passage

return eligibility	退貨資格	policy
returnable	可退貨／可退回的	eligibility
non-returnable	不可退貨的	passage
returnable bottle	可退回重用的樽	reuse
return policy	退貨政策	retail
returns policy	退貨政策	BrE/business
return window	可退貨期限	retail
return period	退貨期	retail
return postage	退貨郵費	passage
return shipping	退貨運費	logistics
return label	退貨標籤	logistics
return rate	退貨率	passage
return pattern	退貨模式	passage
free returns	免費退貨	retail
return to X	返回 X	movement
return from X	從 X 回來	movement
return home	回家	movement
return (reappear)	再次出現	recurrence
return of X	X 的回歸	recurrence
return to normal	恢復正常	state
return to form	恢復水準	performance
return to work	復工	activity

return to service	恢復服務	operation
return something	歸還某物	give back
return equipment	歸還設備	possession
return to sender	退回寄件人	post
return address	回郵／寄件人地址	post
return a call	回電話	response
return a smile	回以微笑	reciprocity
return a greeting	回應問候	reciprocity
return a compliment	回敬讚美	reciprocity
return a favour	還人情	reciprocity
return fire	還擊	retaliation
in return	作為回報	reciprocity
in return for X	作為 X 的交換／回報	exchange
return journey	回程	travel
return flight	回程航班	travel
return ticket	來回票	BrE travel
a return (ticket)	來回票	BrE shorthand
return visit	回訪	reciprocal visit
return match	次回合比賽	sport
return (finance)	回報；收益	investment
return on investment	投資回報	finance
rate of return	回報率	finance

annual return	年度回報	finance
total return	總回報	finance
return a profit	錄得／產生盈利	business
diminishing returns	報酬遞減	economics
point of diminishing returns	回報遞減點	economics
tax return	報稅表／申報	tax
file a tax return	報稅	tax
returns (reports)	統計／申報資料	administration
return a verdict	作出裁決	law
return the ball	回擊球	sport
return serve	接發球回擊	sport
a return (sport)	回球	sport
kick return	開球回攻	sport
return a value	回傳值	programming
return value	回傳值	programming
return statement	return 敘述	programming
return code	回傳碼	programming
Return key	Return／Enter 鍵	keyboard
carriage return	回車	computing
return receipt	回執	post
point of no return	無法回頭的臨界點	idiom
return to a topic	回到話題	discourse

return something to normal	使恢復正常	causative
return of symptoms	症狀復發	recurrence
returning customer	回頭客	repeat business

For your original passage

Your passage uses **return** as a whole retail-policy system, not merely “send something back”:

every **return request** should require an order number...

= 每宗退貨申請

the item would no longer qualify for **return**

= 商品不再符合退貨資格

hygiene-sensitive goods should remain **non-returnable**

= 衛生敏感商品應繼續不可退貨

Return postage could be paid by customers...

= 退貨郵費

unusual return patterns flagged for review

= 異常退貨模式

review ... return rates

= 檢視退貨率

The cleanest learner contrast is:

return = 商品回到商戶

exchange = 把商品換成另一件

refund = 金錢退回顧客

replacement = 商戶提供替代商品

store credit = 不退現金, 而給未來消費額度

returnable = 商品可以退回

refundable = 款項可以退還

return rate = 退貨比例

returning customer = 回頭客, 不是「正在退貨的顧客」

And for this passage specifically, that last distinction is especially nice:

high return rate = 很多商品被退回 → usually undesirable

high customer return rate / many returning customers = 很多顧客再次購買 →
usually desirable

Same word **return**, but almost opposite business implications depending on **what is returning**.